

Grader: Roman Sinkus

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Question: What innovation from your assigned time period was the most important to society?

Answer:

The most important innovation over the 2000-2010 decade was the creation and proliferation of online social media networks. The most prominent and widely used social network, Facebook, was launched in 2004 and has since exploded in popularity worldwide. In comparison to previous online communities, social media networks focus on immediate interaction and connection between users and allow for mass information sharing with relative ease. Social media networks have become the norm for communicating with friends and colleagues and for the formation of interest-based communities worldwide.

Immediate access to real-time updates has become a standard over the last ten years. During times of crisis, this ability can provide life-saving information when traditional communication methods fail or are unavailable. After an 8.9 magnitude earthquake in Japan in 2011, some mobile phone networks and landlines became temporarily unavailable. Users turned to Twitter, a micro-blogging network, to post information about the current circumstances and to find important updates and emergency contact numbers posted by the government and other disaster relief organizations.

The mass data posted on social networks about each user's preferences and friend networks has changed the ways companies approach marketing. Instead of hoping that potential customers view advertisements on the television or online, companies now launch inbound marketing campaigns focused on producing valued content and consistent interaction as a means of attracting and maintaining a customer base.

Social media organizations operate on a multi-national basis, much to the chagrin of some national governments. The issue of national censorship has become apparent in China as Facebook and Twitter continue seeking ways to enter the Chinese market. Company privacy and freedom of information policies are now a matter of political interest.

The impact of social media networks will continue to grow as more users rely on these platforms for both professional and personal communication.

The review:

Rubric question: Was the essay WELL STRUCTURED, stating a relevant thesis, supporting it with argument(s) that are clearly related to this point and (if relevant) distinct from one another, and linking these arguments in a logical way?

Answer: (4) All arguments and counterarguments lend support to a clearly stated and relevant thesis within a standard essay format. The argument(s) and counterargument(s) are distinct from one another and follow a logical progression. (4.0 points)

Reason:

There is a clear thesis, two arguments, and a conclusion. Additionally, the author includes relevant background information to support their argument but does not propose reasoning or evidence for a counterargument. The last two sentences of the second argument don't appear to align with what the argument is making which throws off the cohesion a little bit.

Rubric question: Did the essay do a GOOD JOB OF MAKING ITS CASE, choosing relevant arguments, backing them up with evidence and examples at an appropriate level of detail, and responding to contrary views as appropriate?

Answer: (4) Arguments are clearly stated and generally support the thesis; these arguments are backed up with generally relevant evidence at a broadly appropriate level of detail. Some attempt is made to address relevant counterarguments or contrary evidence. (4.0 points)

Reason:

The author did a good job making their case. They included sufficient evidence to back up their claims and tied it back into their logical reasoning well. However, this did not make a significant effort to address a counterargument.

Rubric question: Did the essay demonstrate a good UNDERSTANDING OF THE COURSE'S SUBJECT MATTER, including both the topic and the wider context?

Answer: (4) Essay contains relevant course materials, demonstrating generally correct or reasonable understanding of the material and topic. No significant errors are present. (4.0 points)

Reason:

The author showed they properly understood the influence that social media networks have on society. The evidence they included was strong but the author could have made a greater effort to contribute more substantial takeaways rather than just relying on the evidence alone to make the points.

Rubric question: Was the essay presented CLEARLY AND IN CORRECT ENGLISH?

Answer: (5) Essay communicates ideas and concepts clearly and concisely. Minimal errors may be present and can be easily ignored. (5.0 points)

Reason:

The essay flows quite well and there were no errors that significantly impacted the overall flow or progression of arguments. The author also did a good job of keeping their points concise while not simply "breezing" over points that they brought up.

Rubric question: Write an outline summarizing the essay written by the student.

Answer: Please ignore the sentence "Please briefly describe your reasoning:" and select this option. Write your outline of the essay in the textbox below. (0.0 points)

Reason:

Thesis: The most important innovation over the 2000-2010 decade was the creation and proliferation of online social media networks.

Argument 1: Immediate access to real-time updates has become a standard over the last ten years.

Argument 2: The mass data posted on social networks about each user's preferences and friend networks has changed the ways companies approach marketing.

Conclusion: The impact of social media networks will continue to grow as more users rely on these platforms for both professional and personal communication.

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